

Make Hard Work Your Passion: Commitment, Featuring Marie Mouchet

Coach Pat Summitt

“How can you make work fun? You can’t. At least not entirely. Fun is the wrong word for something that makes your back hurt, your hands stiff and your headache. Work is drudgery, grind, toil, but you can make your work more satisfying. The first step is to commit to it. Decide to do it well.”

Marie Mouchet, VP & CIO Colonial Pipeline Company

Coach Summitt loved daily practices even more than the games. Practices provided Pat and her assistants the opportunity to engage in what they enjoyed most -- teaching. Pat believed her players deeply desired success and that her primary role was to guide them in how to achieve it. She knew success wasn’t a switch to turn on in game time. It had to be developed. Speaking on her program’s high standards for work ethic, Pat said ...

Coach Pat Summitt

“The harder you work, the harder it is to surrender. Tennessee wins because in the end, our players feel they’ve worked too hard not to.”

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To foster a high level of commitment, surround yourself with a community that shares your work ethic and respects your drive. Pat Summitt never disguised the commitment level she required from her players. She openly communicated Tennessee’s high standards and values, knowing that those who were not deterred by the promise of hard work were exactly the ones who would fit in her program. She said, “There is an unspoken understanding that develops between like-minded people who share a goal. The understanding is, ‘Only you know, and I know how hard we are willing to work on each other’s behalf.’”

Who’s on your team? Do they share your desire for success? Teams that share a similar understanding of the value of work will pursue similar standards of excellence. Shared passion for success fuels the commitment to keep improving and working hard, no matter the cost.